

Pacman for women

The creator of Pacman, Toru Iwatani, said the game was developed to attract women to arcades

HP-Palm tablet

HP to soon launch tablet powered by Palm's WebOS

Cellphone test

In addition the TouchWiz interface incorporates the widget feature, with built-in mini applications, that can be activated with a swipe or gesture of a finger. It also allows users to drag widgets from the left panel of the screen and drop them anywhere on the home screen.

The touchscreen interface provides vibrational feedback when an icon is selected or when a message or number is typed on the screen using the touchscreen keypad. This phone is crash-happy, freezing intermittently and randomly, sometimes all on its own. The hardware QWERTY keypad is well laid-out. The onscreen keyboard has convenient spacing and offers a fair bit of accuracy. We found it quite ideal for typing lengthy messages and dialing phone numbers with ease. Another impressive aspect involves an auto-fill feature that stores previously dialed numbers in phone's memory, even if the user forgets to add them into his contacts list.

The Verdict:

Samsung Corby could have come across as a decent social networking phone because of the hardware keyboard, had it been more stable. It fared well in the build quality and ergonomics test with well designed body contours, user friendly menu interface and consistent touch response. It had a good outing in the call clarity test, except for the loudspeaker test where it delivered rough voice overtones at higher vol-

umes and also produced poor voice clarity. Although, it took a downward slide in the captured photo and video quality test with poor performance. It offers a good feature set at a decent price.

Samsung S5620 Monte

The Samsung S5620 Monte is basically targeted at the budget conscious, social networking segment. It has a glossy black finish on the front panel with the 'select', 'call answer' and 'call disconnect' buttons placed at the bottom. Its aerodynamic design and well rounded golden-orange side panels add to the stylish design and glamour quotient of the mobile. The volume controls are conveniently placed on one side panel and the microSD slot, 'camera' and 'lock' button on the other.

Samsung S5620 Monte

It has a touchscreen design similar to the B5310 CorbyPro. However, it lacks the hardware keypad which is a major drawback. The touchscreen employs a user friendly interface with well organized menu icons. However, the touchscreen is not responsive and often lags during phone navigation. It has a widget feature similar to the B5310 CorbyPro, with a sidebar containing useful widgets which can also be dragged and dropped onto the home screen.

The Verdict:

It is a fairly average performer

in the captured photo and video quality test. It does not impress in the loudspeaker test with a score of 8 on 10. It had consistent results throughout the signal reception and call clarity test. Hence, it fancies its chances as a good mid-end phone with a decent camera and good music player, at an affordable price.

LG GT505

The LG GT505 is a mid-level touchscreen social networking phone. It has a hard plastic body with a grey brushed metallic finish on 'select' and 'call control' buttons and back panel. The contours of the body are well rounded for a comfortable grip. It ships with a scratch-proof LCD screen sticker, bundled earphones/hands-free set and battery charger. The battery cover is well built with a slide and click mechanism. The side panels feature the volume control buttons, USB/power slot, lockbutton and the camera button on one side and microSD slot on the other.

The front buttons and side panel buttons produce good tactile feedback. These buttons are well placed for ease of access to the user. The touchscreen interface incorporates a home screen with widget like menu system including call access, personal profile, messaging and communication as sub-categories. The touchscreen is quite sluggish and does not register the input on several occasions, especially while typing.

The Verdict:

LG GT505 had a consistent outing in the signal reception and call clarity test. However, it lost out in the captured photo and captured video test with an ordinary score. It did a fair job in the bundled earphones test with a score of 8 on 10. It does not impress as a good multimedia phone due to a poorly built loudspeaker and lack of good bass in the audio output. Also, the lack of quality camera lens makes it a poor choice for video recording. Hence, at Rs. 17,000, it leaves a lot to be desired as a mid-range phone.

LG GW550

A full QWERTY candy-bar phone priced at Rs. 17,500, the GW550 looks similar to the Nokia E72, with near identical keypad layouts. It is meant to be a business/messaging phone, and is a 3G enabled device, loaded with Windows Mobile 6.5 Standard. The phone does not have a 3.5mm audio jack, and you will have to use the proprietary USB headset, though it



LG GT505



LG GW550